Final Project Grading Rubric

Presentation

Group Component: (15 points)

Slides & Presentation

- Engaging and easy to follow
- Project is adequately motivated – why is this topic important?
- Topic is connected to appropriate readings/scientific research (from our reading list or otherwise)
- Data and methods are described with enough detail for class to follow (if using methods from outside our class, give an overview of what these are doing)
- Methodological decisions are justified – why is your analysis the right approach?
- Results and potential implications are discussed (results may be preliminary, but be sure to discuss what they mean)
- Slides are visually appealing and data is presented creatively/effectively
- Next steps and/or possible future directions are mentioned
- During Q&A, team engages with questions, including any coding challenges and/or data issues that were encountered are discussed and how the team dealt with these
- The team is engaged during other groups' presentations
- The team sticks to time limitations

Collaboration/Individual Component: (5 points)

Contributions to Slides/Work

- Contribution of each team member is acknowledged (each person does not necessarily have to present their part)
- Team member collaborated with others and documented collaboration (e.g. through GitHub)
- Team is respectful and engaged in other teams' presentations

Document

Group Components:

Motivation: (5 points)

- Research question is clearly stated
- Importance of research question is conveyed, with references to prior research from academia/journalism/statements from government or non-government organizations
- Research is related to a topic of social science interest
- Research uses computational methods

Data: (5 points)

- Data are clearly explained, including the source that these come from and any relevant information about how they were collected
- The procedures taken to obtain these data are detailed
- The relevance of these data are shown – why are these the right data for the question?
- Where appropriate, the team uses features of R (e.g. head() or other functions to display parts of the data and demonstrate the data format)
- If the team joins different datasets, these processes are explained
- If there are missing data, the team explains how these are handled
- Limitations or drawbacks of the data are discussed openly

Methods: (5 points)

- The methods are appropriate to the research question
- Relevant background information is provided on what each method is doing
- The methods are correctly applied
- Any pre-processing steps are noted to put data in the right format to use the methods
- When multiple choices are present in terms of methods, the team explains why they chose one option over another (if the team uses default options, these are noted and justified)
- The results from these methods are correctly interpreted
- If some methods failed to work or provide ambiguous results, these are discussed openly

Conclusions: (5 points)

- The implications of the research are presented clearly and effectively
- The report is a reasonable length (probably ~5 pages of text and ~10 pages of code and results, but this can vary a lot. Quality is always preferred to quantity!)

Style and Formatting: (5 points)

- The format of the document (e.g. website, paper, pdf, html, etc.) is well-designed and fits with the purpose of the document
- Stylistically, the document is easy to read and nicely organized
- Teams specify the contributions of each member to the final project

Collaboration/Individual Components:

Code/Writing: (10 points)

- Code and writing are combined in a way that is easy to follow
- Code is well-annotated (comments throughout noting what each part is doing)
- Writing is clear and accurately describes the coding processes
- It is clear what code/writing the team member contributed (for example, this is tracked through GitHub and explained in detail)

Decision-Making: (5 points)

- The team details how each member contributed to the project ideation and decision-making along the course of the project
- The member contributed to solid decision-making around at least one of: motivation, data, methods, writing, and/or style
- The member incorporated course materials and insights into decision-making